

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

- The patient describes long-standing sadness, feelings of hopelessness, worsening suicidal ideations, and problems with decision-making.

- He also describes concentration difficulties, which are all consistent with depressive symptoms.

- The fact that these symptoms have worsened over the past two weeks, especially considering that the patient mentions having had them for as long as he can remember, suggests a worsening of an already pre-existing depressive condition, which is the hallmark of double depression.

- Mania or psychosis is not suggested by the description, as these conditions typically include elevated mood, energy, or grandiosity, and the patient's symptoms are more consistent with depression.

- Anhedonia is a common symptom of depression, but it's not the best fit for the overall picture presented.

- Paranoid personality disorder is a chronic pattern of distrust and suspiciousness, which does not align with the patient's description of symptoms.

- Therefore, the best fit is the patient being at risk for double depression.

- The patient's job-holding capacity and normal sleep suggest that there are no significant functional impairments, and no psychotic symptoms.

- The patient's long history of depressive symptoms and the recent worsening fit the criteria for double depression.

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<answer>A</answer>